

This is the what to cook window at it needs a lot of design work. Ive tried to design it with the plan to properly print a weeks worth of meals on regular printer paper, but its always printed so horribly. It takes 11 - 13 pages each week. The font isnt even that large. Its just with the layout theres so much underused space. How could I better design this so it actually looks like a traditional cookbook and only take 1 to 2 pages when printed out, even with all of this information displayed

You are **absolutely right** that the *What To Cook* window prints extremely inefficiently — and after inspecting the HTML structure you provided  *What To Cook* , I can clearly see **why it explodes into 11–13 pages**:

Here’s the root cause:

1. **Every day is a card with huge vertical padding.**
2. **Every meal is its own “block”** with borders, spacing, and a multi-line header.
3. **Ingredients are shown in nested flexbox structures with large margins.**
4. **Portion breakdowns for each user are printed inline**, multiplying vertical height dramatically.
5. **The layout intentionally avoids page breaks**, which forces the browser to shove content downward.
6. **Grid layout for days / meals isn’t print-friendly** — grid tends to force full-width stacking in print mode.

Even with small fonts, the *structure* forces high vertical expansion.

But here’s the good news:

★ **We can redesign this to print 1–2 pages by restructuring it like a traditional cookbook layout.**

Not by hiding information — by **changing the information density strategy**.

★ What Your Printed Pages *Should* Look Like

(Think *Meal Prep Cookbooks*, *NYT Cooking Print Layout*, *Blue Apron Weekly Sheet*)

One week = 1 page (ideal) or 2 pages (max)

Each day becomes a **horizontal section**, not an independent card.

Each meal becomes just **one line per ingredient**, not a giant block.

Each meal doesn’t get its own “card” — it gets a **compact recipe-list style section**.

★ Proposed Printed Layout (Dramatically Condensed)

Here is a clean, professional, cookbook-style print structure:

WEEKLY COOKING PLAN

Date Range: 2025-12-09 → 2025-12-15

TUESDAY (Dec 9)

PREP AHEAD

• (none)

COOK TODAY

Instant Breakfast – PB Banana Smoothie (2.5 portions)

- Soy Milk: 2.5 cups (W:1 / M:0.5 / B:1)
- Protein Powder: 2.5 oz (W:1 / M:0.5 / B:1)
- Banana: 2.5 each
- Peanut Butter: 2.5 tbsp
- Bran: 2.5 tbsp

Fettuccine Alfredo w/ Ham & Veg (5 portions) (Leftovers for Dec 10)

- Alfredo Sauce: 20 oz
- Fettuccine: 12.5 oz cooked → 6.3 oz dry
- Ham Steak: 20 oz
- Parsley: 1.3 small bunch
- Bell Pepper: 2.5 each
- Onion: 1.3 medium
- Zucchini: 2.5 medium
- Butter, Garlic, Salt, Black Pepper

Snack – Egg & Carrot Sticks (2.5 portions)

- Eggs: 2.5
- Carrots: 10.6 oz

And then Wednesday printed directly below...

No cards, no blocks, no grids.

Everything is compact, readable, and wastes zero space.

★ Why This Fits 1–2 Pages Instead of 11–13

✓ Remove cards

Cards = tons of padding + borders + spacing.

✓ Remove nested blocks + subcontainers

Your current layout uses flexbox grids with separate boxes for each ingredient.

Traditional cookbook layout uses **simple list lines**.

✓ Flatten user breakdowns

Instead of a giant nested list per ingredient:

```
Soy Milk: 2.5 cups (W:1 / M:0.5 / B:1)
```

This alone cuts ingredient height by ~80%.

✓ No grids in print mode

CSS grid is not print-efficient.

The proposed layout uses simple block sections.

✓ One unified flow instead of day cards

Page printing works best when allowed to naturally flow, not when given card boundaries.

✓ Smaller print-specific paddings / fonts

Your `@media print` still preserves large paddings and margins.

We reduce paddings drastically for print.